



The Sensoria Socks

The anklet channels the information from the sensors to the smartphone, which can be displayed on Sensoria's proprietary mobile application.

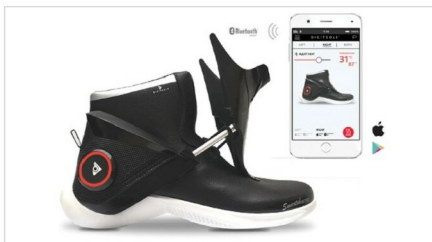
The app is compatible with both Android and iOS and measures metrics in real time during running, walking or even when doing stretches. It has all the essential features including dashboard view of the metrics, audio-guidance as well as navigation tracker. The socks are completely washable. In the box, you get a pair of socks, an anklet and an anklet charger. The package costs \$199 (about ₹12,800).

Back home, Ducere Technologies has developed a smart shoe called **LeChal**. Originally built to aid the visually impaired, the shoe is finding general-purpose commercial applications too. LeChal comes in three iterations: a whole shoe, a sole or a small pod. The main element is haptic sensors, which help to direct the traveller without referring to a GPS. Basically, the LeChal mobile application can connect with the shoe via Bluetooth and configure the system.

To get directions, users can download their maps locally. Based on the stored GPS, the haptic sensors send different vibratory signals through the shoe, indicating different directions to be followed. LeChal also acts as a fitness evaluator, measuring the distance covered in a session, the time of the session, calories burnt and so on. The battery of the system runs for 15 days with a single charge. LeChal is priced at ₹ 6999.



The LeChal package



Digitsole smart shoe (kickstarter.com)



Digitsole Warm series (digitsole.com)

There are even more innovative smart footwear out there—some are commercially available, while others are under development. For instance, Digitsole has developed a smart shoe that can do everything starting from auto-configuring itself for metrics evaluation to auto-tightening.

Yet another offering from Digitsole, Warm series auto-regulates the temperature of your feet based on the environment. It keeps you warm in the coldest of winter days. Altra IQ is an all-round smart shoe with distributed sensors. Runscribe is another portable gadget that can clutch onto any shoe to make it smart. **EFY**